



WITH MODERN T20 SURFACES OFFERING LITTLE ASSISTANCE TO BOWLERS, VYSHAK HAS LEANED INTO PRECISION INSTEAD OF OUTFOXING BATTERS WITH VARIETY



looking forward to,” Vyshak said after briefly holding the Purple Cap following the game against Chennai Super Kings (**facing page**).

Vyshak may not be a huge fan of number-crunching, but there is a clear trend that has emerged in how he has steadily reduced his reliance on variations. In 2023, 33.33 per cent of his deliveries were variations. The following year, that dropped to 29.89, and last year, it came down further to 20.59 per cent. It’s still early days in the ongoing edition, but the number seems to have nosedived to 10.41.

The change reflects both personal evolution and the demands of modern T20 surfaces, which offer little assistance to bowlers. Instead of outfoxing batters with variety, Vyshak has leaned into precision.

“The video analyst plays one of the biggest roles in the team by telling you what lines and lengths to bowl. It also depends on the wickets. If you’re confident in doing what you’re supposed to do at the end of the day and if you’re hitting the right lengths, it doesn’t matter which batter you are bowling to. If you bowl the right lengths, you are a good bowler, and nobody is going to hit you. ‘More practice, the better’ has been my mantra. The more I do in the nets, the more I think about the game, the more I visualise it, the better it works.”

In an IPL ecosystem increasingly defined by excess — more runs, extra risk, and ever-flowing boundaries — Vyshak has managed to market his wares through restraint. For someone long caught between promise and arrival, this might finally be the year the gap begins to close.

PIC: PUNJAB KINGS

